# Shadowing Day Report

Wednesday, October 14, 2026: Customer Service (Charmaine) and Accounts Receivable (Suzanne)

Times marked ~ are estimates from the order of events. The original notes only have a few exact timestamps. Text in *italics* inside quotation parentheses are the observer's own asides, kept from the notes.

## The Day at a Glance

| Time | Activity |
|---|---|
| 9:45 to 12:15 | Shadowing **Charmaine** (Customer Service) |
| 12:15 to ~2:45 | Lunch and an online appointment (not shadowing) |
| 2:45 | Mincha |
| 3:00 to 4:30 | Shadowing **Suzanne** (AR) |
| ~4:30 | Interruption from Tina about the reporting app (observer's own work) |

## Part 1: Charmaine, Customer Service (9:45 to 12:15)

**Systems and tools:** F&O, CHUB, Lowes portal (WebEDI), Wayfair portal, Mason portal, email, Teams, FedEx and UPS tracking, a printed Lowes procedure manual, printed email templates.

| Time | Episode | Type |
|---|---|---|
| 9:48 | Amazon customer asks for a replacement | Phone |
| 9:54 | Wayfair cancellation and Mason open orders | Portal admin |
| ~10:00 to 10:20 | Lowes missed cancellation → manual 810 invoice | Portal admin |
| 10:20 | Lowes CS: wrong tile pattern shipped | Phone |
| ~10:30 | Email triage, round 1 (Nexus/retro tile, Morningstar, etc.) | Email |
| ~10:40 | Lowes invoice follow-up and Kohls shade call | Portal / Phone |
| ~10:45 | Email triage, round 2 (voicemails, Morningstar reply) | Email |
| ~10:50 | Filing the printed Lowes pending list | Paper |
| 11:00 to 11:04 | Sample order request to Justin | Email |
| ~11:05 | Voicemail: customer wants to buy direct | Voicemail |
| Recurring | Mason portal checks | Portal admin |
| ~11:15 | Email triage, round 3 (Kart It, Wayfair overdue, gift valance) | Email |
| ~11:30 to 12:15 | Home Depot ship-to-store call and UPS claim | Phone |
| During UPS hold | Retro tile customer replies → escalated to Avi G | Email |

| Time | Episode | Type |
|---|---|---|
| End | Teams down → calls Brandon for packaging info | Phone |

## What happened

### Amazon and Kohls customers (calls and emails)

Three separate contacts came from customers who bought through other retailers: an Amazon replacement request, an Amazon misaligned-print complaint, and a Kohls noisy shade. Each time Charmaine told them to go back through the retailer. The Amazon caller said Amazon had given her wrong information and told her to call Achim. Our items don't fall under the 30-day return policy, and the call was repetitive because the customer wouldn't accept it.

### Wayfair and Mason (portal admin)

- A Wayfair cancellation email came in. She verified it in the Wayfair portal and in F&O.
- Mason emailed about open orders. She entered the invoice numbers into F&O one by one (e.g. IN001041663, 41684, 41667).
- For large batches she downloads a file from Mason, fills it in and re-uploads it. This time there were only a few, so she did them manually.
- Manual path: Sales order → My view → filter by PO → Invoice → open the invoice (extra step) → copy and paste.
- Nine new Wayfair orders arrived today, to be checked at lunch for shipping.
- She checks Mason periodically against F&O. Mason doesn't close orders automatically, so she closes them by hand.

### Lowes missed cancellation → manual invoice (~10:00 to 10:20)

Lowes asked for a cancellation. Charmaine emailed Keith and got no response. When she checked, the order was already invoiced, so the cancellation was missed. Because of that, CHUB can't invoice it and she has to invoice manually on the Lowes portal. Lowes sometimes pays these and sometimes doesn't, and it's unclear who dropped the ball.

**The manual process:**

1. Sign in to the portal and wait for the OTP code (she sits and waits), then enter it manually. She signs in and out every time, so every visit has an OTP wait.
2. WebEDI → transaction 810 → create new.
3. Select a remit-to account. Copy the PO date, invoice type, currency code, PO received date and PO actual ship date from the order.
4. Add tracking, check FedEx to confirm it's out for delivery, then add the PO number, invoice date and invoice number.
5. Add the Lowes buying store number from CHUB. *(The observer thinks it may exist elsewhere too, but she uses CHUB.)*
6. Add items one by one. The item number and description come from CHUB, and the unit code and price from F&O.
7. Check her manual for allowances (none) and discounts (not applicable). Net due days: 60.

8. Shipment and payment method: from F&O (order → shipment). Method = collect, BOL = tracking number, carrier = FedEx.
9. **Error 1:** The first save lost the item line because she hadn't clicked "Add item." She re-entered it.
10. **Error 2:** The first submit failed because the discount description was blank. She checked the manual and entered "not applicable."
11. Finished at 10:20.

Afterwards she remembered she had forgotten to print the list of pending manual invoices. She printed the web page itself, so it looks bad. She keeps the printed lists on her desk with previous ones and follows up with Suzanne to see whether they have been paid.

Side note: before returning to this claim, she took a break to email Jhony. A customer on the phone was missing a part, so she asked whether we have replacements for the Buono II Bradford Rod white plastic plug. She checked the email twice before sending. *(The observer was pleasantly surprised.)*

### Lowes CS call: wrong tile pattern (10:20)

Lowes customer service reported that a customer received two items incorrectly. Charmaine opened the order, pulled warehouse tracking and checked FedEx. Everything shipped in one box. She verified the catalog item number against CHUB, asked for the pattern numbers from the boxes, and checked the batch number on the back. She also offered to talk to the customer directly.

The customer ordered 5 boxes of FTV462 and received 44820 instead of 46220 on 2 of them (3 were correct). **Resolution:** Lowes credits the customer, who keeps the tiles, and then places a new order. Charmaine doesn't enter orders in the new system anymore, and since Lowes has an allowance she tells them to credit and reorder.

*(The observer noted it is odd for 3 of 5 identical items to ship right and 2 wrong. It happens from time to time, and the patterns look nothing alike.)*

### Email triage (three rounds)

- **2023 customer:** the item broke, the replacement arrived damaged, and there is no order info at all. Saved for later.
- **Morningstar blind:** arrived without a wand or hardware. She forwarded it to Evelyn, then replied that it will ship by end of week with tracking to follow, and apologized for the inconvenience.
- **Gift recipient:** wants to order hardware after receiving the blind as a gift without it.
- **Previous house owner:** wants a replacement valance for a mahogany MF blind (similar to the gift email).
- **Nexus tile lifting off the floor:** in CHUB it was a retro floor tile from Home Depot, ordered in August. She copied the images into the reply, apologized profusely, and asked whether the tiles were acclimated, what the subfloor is, and whether the temperature is regulated. She reread it twice and sent it. The customer later replied that she acclimated for a week, the temperature is 70, and the subfloor is concrete. Charmaine escalated it to Avi G. *(Acclimated means letting the tiles sit in the room before installation.)*
- **Kart It return:** she checked tracking to confirm it reached the warehouse.
- **Wayfair overdue alert:** she checked the portal and found nothing overdue.

- **Voicemail emails:** one had nothing on it, and the other led her to search her emails for the match.
- She checks and rechecks her emails constantly. She also reviewed the sample order email to Justin many times against a printed sheet, taking **4 minutes (11:00 to 11:04)** to write one email. It asked Justin (cc Baruch, Peleg and Chani) to enter a no-charge sample order, send back the sales order number, and package carefully to avoid damage.

### Other calls

- A voicemail from a customer who ordered from Lowes and wants more at a lower price, so he wants to order straight from Achim. She didn't respond. *(She takes her headset off every time she listens to a voicemail.)*
- A Kohls customer called about a shade that makes noise going up and down. She told them to contact Kohls for a replacement. The customer asked many questions about Kohls' return policy.

### Home Depot ship-to-store call and UPS claim (~11:30 to 12:15)

Home Depot CS reported a ship-to-store order with 2 items missing. CHUB showed multiple boxes. On UPS, all showed delivered except two, which show delayed in Stafford, TX and appear lost. **Resolution:** the customer places a replacement order and we file a UPS claim. *(The order was somehow closed without being received short. The observer thinks she was talking to a Home Depot rep.)*

Charmaine wrote everything down, called UPS and waited on hold. Teams wasn't working (she had emailed Peleg yesterday with no reply), so she called Brandon to get the packaging details UPS needed: cushioning, single or double wall, and tape type. She picked Brandon because he is the easiest to reach, rather than Jhony or anyone else in the warehouse.

## Part 2: Suzanne, AR (3:00 to 4:30)

**Systems and tools:** F&O (customer payments, journals), InOrder (still used for phone numbers), desk calculator, paper checks and remittances, email, highlighters.

**Working relationship:** Chani (AP and office manager) deposits checks, scans them and sends them to Suzanne. She also gives Suzanne a paperclipped pile for each batch.

| Time | Episode |
|---|---|
| 3:00 to ~3:05 | Deductions list sent to Avi (Lowes, Home Depot) |
| ~3:05 to 3:08 | Account breakdown call to David Dweck (sales) |
| 3:08 to 3:13 | Calling Herman's about a postdated check |
| 3:13 to 3:22 | Payment entry, customer 5121 |
| 3:22 to ~3:28 | Customer 472: wrong tariff deduction |
| ~3:28 | Customer 462: $200 short-pay email |
| 3:30 | Customer 11598 |
| ~3:30 to 3:45 | New journal: deposit structure and errors |
| ~3:45 to 3:50 | Matching a batch to Chani's email |
| 3:50 to ~4:10 | Batches that won't post |

| Time | Episode |
|---|---|
| ~4:10 to 4:30 | Return → credit memo |

## What happened

### Deductions list (3:00)

She sent a list of Lowes and Home Depot deductions to Avi, cc Chani, Tina and Isaac. It had taken her a couple of days. *(She had InOrder open!?!?!)*

### Call with David Dweck (salesman, ext. 123)

She gave him a breakdown on customer 6903: they order about every 2 months, do about $12k a year, and are good business but used to order more often. Mid-call, Chani brought in a check from HD Supply and took it to her office to add to a deposit batch. It will come back after deposit.

### Herman's (1098), 3:08 to 3:13

Path: Customer payments → Menu → Customers → Herman's. The phone number wasn't in F&O, so she got it from InOrder *(two years after the switch to F&O)*, then added the number and the email to F&O. No pickup on the first call, so she used her cell phone. A woman named Pam answered, and Suzanne asked for Ricky, who was at the other store. She asked Pam to remind him to email the postdated check.

### Payment entry (3:13 to 3:30)

*(She was nervous with the observer watching.)*

- **Customer 5121 (3:13 to 3:22).** Add payment → date, reference, amount → tick off orders at the bottom, matching the remittance. She made a mistake, rechecked, and unticked the wrong ones. She scrolls down the list instead of sorting or filtering, and the invoices skipped around, so each had to be hand-checked. She saved the journal, then entered a "destroy in field" deduction for the remainder. That is a deduction reason on the credit: the customer throws the goods out and we write them off.
- **Customer 472.** Same steps. They claimed deductions, so she used a desk calculator to check the math. They also took a tariff deduction, which is wrong. She left it open and told Avi, Mendy and others to go back to the customer to fix it. She highlighted her notes at the bottom of the check and set it aside.
- **Customer 462.** They shorted the payment by $200. She emailed them to ask why and had a hard time wording it. *(Could use a template.)* She highlighted her notes and set it aside.
- **Customer 11598 (3:30).** She matched the remittance to open invoices as before and left the journal open because of issues.

*The observer assumed she applies payments to the top orders and works down. What was observed was invoice-by-invoice matching against the remittance. That may be the norm, or she may have been extra careful because she was being watched. Worth asking her.*

### How deposits are structured

For every journal she deletes the default description and enters the deposit amount as the name. Every deposit is one journal entry, and every check on the deposit is a customer payment.

- Customer 5194 sent postdated checks, so she entered it as a partial payment.
- Customer 6102 matched an invoice exactly.
- She applied the last 4 payments to the previous journal by mistake, so she deleted it, created a new one and re-added them. *(She got distracted talking to the observer.)*

### Matching a batch to Chani's email (~3:45 to 3:50)

Chani gives Suzanne a paperclipped pile of checks, with a calculator total slip printed at deposit time. Chani also emails the scanned checks and deposit batch. Suzanne takes the total from the slip and searches her email for that amount to find the right message. She then checks the math on deductions and credits while entering payments from the remittance. *(The observer: this is where I see the fun.)*

### Batches that won't post (3:50 to ~4:10)

- **Batch 1.** After rechecking all the checks, it errored. She set it aside with the other open batches. There was an extra payment, and once she found and deleted it, the batch posted.
- **Batch 2.** It also failed, and she couldn't find the issue. She deleted a payment and re-entered it, then figured it out: the method of payment had defaulted to credit card, but they paid by check. She changed it and it posted.

### Return → credit memo (~4:10 to 4:30)

The reason behind the earlier deduction came back: it was a return we had picked up. She printed the customer's attachment to attach to the batch. Because the batch had already posted, she created a credit memo. To verify the amount she went Customer → Balance → Sales order → View details → Show invoice → Lines, added up the pricing, and confirmed it matched the deduction taken off the check.

## Part 3: Observer's Own Work (not part of either process study)

Around 4:30 Tina asked about the sales reporting app. She is excited about creating her own reports. After clearing it with Avi and Baruch, the observer turned off the daily jobs (so reports stop going to everyone every day) and turned off test mode, so users' own schedules now send. Tina and Tatty (Isaac Grossman, the CEO) can now get their reports.

## Open Items

- Charmaine's times for the middle episodes are estimates. Suzanne's times from 3:22 to 4:30 are also estimates, since the notes only had times through 3:50.
- The lunch and appointment window (12:15 to ~2:45) is blank in the notes.
- Ask Suzanne whether invoice-by-invoice matching is her normal method or was extra care while being observed.

## Part 4: Candidate Pain-Point Modules (for discussion)

The goal of the shadowing is to find groups of pain points that one reusable function could remove together. These are first-pass candidates. Each needs to be confirmed, rejected or reshaped.

| # | Module | What it would do | Episodes touched |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cross-system lookup / match | One search that takes an order, PO, tracking number, customer or amount and returns the order, invoice, shipment, customer contact and batch/email. | Charmaine's CHUB / F&O / FedEx / UPS hopping; Suzanne's InOrder phone numbers; her "search the email for the total" step |
| 2 | Retailer and portal handler | A single place for each retailer's rules, so cancellations, invoices, open orders and deduction lists don't live in a paper manual. | Lowes 810, Wayfair, Mason, Home Depot, Lowes pending list |
| 3 | Intake triage by source | Recognize "this customer bought through Amazon, Kohls or Home Depot" and send the standard reply or the right route at once. | Amazon, Kohls and several email episodes |
| 4 | Templates and checklists | Standard text and field rules for repeated messages: short-pay emails, sample order requests, missing hardware replies, tile complaints (acclimation questions), Lowes invoice fields. | The 4-minute email; Suzanne's wording trouble; the Nexus tile reply |
| 5 | Payment-to-remittance matching | Auto-suggested matching of payments to invoices, with sort and filter, amount defaults, and a post error that says what is wrong. | Most of Suzanne's afternoon |
| 6 | Exception and open-item tracker | One list for items that are "left open" instead of highlighted notes on checks. | Mason orders, tariff deduction, $200 short-pay, lost UPS package, pending Lowes invoices |
| 7 | Defaults and validation | Fix defaults that cause errors: payment method defaulting to credit card, required fields on the 810, item line lost if you don't click Add. | Both days |

**Next step:** decide which modules are real, which are off, and which groupings are missing, then dig into each one.